Cyhana Lena Williams

GenAI UX Research | Geo-Business | Women in STEM

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Professional Summary

A GenAI UX Research Lead and Geospatial Intelligence Specialist with 8+ years of proven record driving enterprise AI initiatives and spatial analytics across technology, agriculture and FMCG sectors. Translating complex behavioral and spatial data into decisions that shape AI products, geo-solutions, route optimization and environmental strategy. Operating at the intersection of human insight and geoai intelligence, independently and across global teams.

Skills and Systems

Mobile: +47 96 874 229 **Location:** Oslo, Norway

Product & Strategy: Research strategy and operations · Systems and spatial thinking · Independent project ownership · Cross-functional leadership · Stakeholder facilitation · Program management · Community and partnership building

AI & Human-Centered Systems: Human-in-the-loop AI model evaluation · Generative AI · AI-augmented research workflows · Human-centered AI systems · UX research · Qualitative and quantitative methods

Geospatial Intelligence: Remote sensing · Satellite imagery and spatial analysis · Spatio-temporal analysis · Route optimization · Cartographic production · Field research coordination

AI & Automation: Claude (Skills creation, AI agents, MCP connectors, Claude Code) · Microsoft 365 Copilot · Prompt and context engineering · AI prototyping (vibe coding)

Research & Design: UserTesting · Figma · FigJam

GIS & Data: ArcGIS Online · ArcMap · QGIS · ENVI · UAV photogrammetry · PostgreSQL · PostGIS · pgAdmin

Work Experience

AI UX Researcher II: M365 AI Enterprise Solutions

Microsoft, Norway | Sept. 2020 - Present

- Co-leading UX research on a computer-use agent (CUA) product team, informing how autonomous agents complete tasks across apps on users' behalf. Previously owned evaluation of visual output for Researcher, the deep research agent in Microsoft 365 Copilot.
- Co-created a human evaluation governance framework for AI outputs that improved AI response quality by 50% and was adopted across multiple UX Research teams as a standard for measuring AI performance.
- Conducted 40+ UX research studies that directly informed the launch of two AI-driven products (Org Explorer and People Agent), with Org Explorer serving all M365 users.
- Led the research initiatives for Generative UI/UX (GenUX) in the M365 AI Experiences shaping core GenUX capabilities across the AI experiences used by global Microsoft customers.
- Collaborated across product, engineering, design, and research teams to translate behavioral insights into actionable product strategy and prioritization decisions.

GIS Mapping Specialist: Route -to-Market Strategy

Coca-Cola Beverages Africa (CCBA), Ghana | Jan. 2019 - Aug. 2020

- Formulated an optimized delivery route system for product distributors out of about 80,000+ customer location data. This helped reduce operational cost by about 50%, provided defined territories for efficient management and prevented distribution territory disputes.
- Mapped operational territories, regions and service zones to improve resource allocation and reduce distribution conflicts.
- Managed and maintained geospatial datasets supporting operational planning, forecasting and geo-business analysis.
- Contributed to the compay's GIS initiatives recognized with the 2020 ESRI Special Achievement in GIS Award. Making Voltic Ghana Limited the only Ghanaian company to win the award that year.

Project Coordinator | Product Manager | UX Researcher | Geospatial Technician: GeoAI Solutions

Henson Geodata Technologies (HGT), Ghana | Sept. 2017 - Aug. 2018

- Pitched IGEZA (now MyAgro360) at the Fall Army Worm Tech Prize in Kampala as one of 20 finalists from 288 applicants. The project went on to win 3rd place (Frontier Innovation Award) at the Cape Town awards ceremony, earning recognition from USAID, Feed the Future, and FFRAR
- Bridged software, data, and farmer research teams to deliver a UI/UX that made complex agricultural tools accessible to end users embedding quality from design through to structured QA testing protocols.
- Built and maintained geospatial databases (QGIS, PostGIS, PostgreSQL) powering Silapha.com's Africa-wide map solutions and produced cartographic work recognized at the AU Agenda 2063 SAATM flagship conference.

Projects

Researcher Agent - AI Agent
Microsoft, Norway | AI UX Researcher | Feb. 2026 - Jul. 2026
Researcher is a deep research agent in Microsoft 365 Copilot that reasons across work data and the web to produce structured, report-style answers. I owned human evaluation of the agent's visual output, assessing the quality of AI-generated visuals and turning findings into product improvements.

People Agent - AI Experience
Microsoft, Norway | AI UX Researcher | Oct. 2024 - Jan. 2026
People Agent is an AI feature in Microsoft 365 that uses Microsoft Graph to show how you're connected to colleagues and what you've worked on together, beyond a static org chart. I led UX research that informed the agent's design and launch, translating user needs into decisions on how people insights are surfaced.

Org Explorer - Software
Microsoft, Norway | UX Researcher | Sept. 2020 - Jul. 2024
Org Explorer lets employees visualize and explore their company's structure, teams and the people around them. I conducted UX research across its development and launch, shaping a product that now serves all Microsoft 365 users.

Route - to - Market Project - GIS
Coca-Cola Beverages Africa, Ghana | GIS Specialist | Jan. 2019 - Aug. 2020
This project optimized distribution from factory and warehouse to distributors and customers through geographically planned routes and territories. I built the route system from 80,000+ customer locations, cutting operational costs by about 50% and contributing to the 2020 Esri Special Achievement in GIS Award.

IGEZA (MyAgro360) - GIS and Software
Henson Geodata Technologies, Ghana | Project Coordinator | Jun. 2018 - Aug. 2018
IGEZA is an AI-powered pest and disease management system that helps farmers detect crop threats, find recommended pesticides nearby and alert agricultural extension officers. I coordinated the software, data and farmer research teams and pitched the product as one of 20 finalists out of 288 applicants, winning the Frontier Innovation Award (3rd place) with the team.

Education

Signal Training School: Soko Aerial Centre for Unmanned Aerial Vehicle Education and Research: Dec. 2019 - Jan. 2020
Certificate of Completion | UAV Piloting and Photogrammetry

UAV or Drone Piloting, Drone Image Processing and Drone Mechanics.

Key Topics: General introduction to UAVs, Ghana Civil Aviation Authority Guide, General system designs of Quadcopters, On-field manual flight exercises, Desktop mission planning of autonomous flights, Drone Image Processing and Introduction to Photogrammetry.

Developers in Vogue: Jul. 2018 - Dec. 2018
Certificate of Completion | Fundamentals of Programming

Under Developers in Vogue Bootcamp, I learnt the basics of software development in HTML, CSS, JavaScript and MySQL.

University of Ghana: Sept. 2013 - May 2017
B.A Geography and Resource Development with Psychology | Second Class Upper Honors

Some activities and roles included: Volta Hall 2015/2016 Administration (Deputy Sports Secretary), Volta Hall Handball Team Captain (2 years), Volta Hall Hockey Team and Volta Hall Cross Country Team

Volunteering

Volunteering

- Mentor, Global Mentorship Initiative via Microsoft Give (2026): Guided a mentee through a 12-week program on career strategy, CV, LinkedIn and workplace performance.
- Judge, International Geospatial Innovation Award (2023): Evaluated innovation submissions against set criteria to help select award winners.
- Watcher Volunteer, IBISA Network (2020-2021): Satellite-based farmland health monitoring for farmer insurance.

Affiliations

Co-Founder, African Women in GIS | Guest Speaker, Women in Geospatial+ and Developers in Vogue | Member, Women Techmakers Accra

Achievements

Microsoft Patent (Contextualized Group Data) | Geospatial World 50 Rising Stars 2021 | Esri Special Achievement in GIS Award 2020 | Featured in Esri's Women and GIS, Vol. 2 | Fall Armyworm Tech Prize, Frontier Innovation Award | Best Sales and Marketing Team, CCBA

Languages

English (Native/Fluent) | Norwegian (A2, studying towards B2)

References

Available upon request.